

Philipp Hilbert. *Technical Product Owner for data-driven enterprise platforms.*

Positioning, Thirteen years of product ownership in regulated industries, with a proven record of taming complex backlogs, leading cross-functional data platform teams, and shipping analytically grounded outcomes at pace.

BERLIN, GERMANY · HILBERT@TRUE-NORTH.BERLIN · TRUE-NORTH.BERLIN
LinkedIn · GitHub · www.true-north.berlin · YouTube (EN sample)

Dear Hiring Team,

I am applying for the Technical Product Owner, Data Science & AI Platform role at Emirates Group. With thirteen years of product ownership across public-sector analytics, defence AI platforms, insurance SaaS, healthcare, and fintech, I have spent the bulk of my career doing exactly what this role describes: owning the full backlog lifecycle across feature, NFR, technical debt, BAU, and spike work, and being the single accountable voice that connects engineering teams to business outcomes.

The role that maps most directly onto what the ACoE is building is my time at the Federal Employment Agency (Bundesagentur für Arbeit), where I owned the national labour-market analytics platform. There I introduced Dagster and dbt to replace manual quarterly imports with automated, auditable data pipelines, cutting time per data update by almost 75%, while simultaneously carrying a full UI relaunch and a large ETL migration. I defined KPIs with policymakers and researchers, maintained data dictionaries and business metadata for each indicator, and acted as Deputy IT Security Officer. That combination of modern data architecture, stakeholder-facing KPI ownership, and operational discipline in a regulated environment mirrors the ACoE's mandate closely.

At Rohde & Schwarz I managed the internal AI and data platform for the FCAS European programme, a multinational delivery programme with 15+ engineers and data scientists. I championed GitOps delivery with ArgoCD that reduced rollout time from days to 30 minutes, and I redirected the product strategy based on instrumented workflow analysis, pipeline runs increased 200% after we deprioritised a UI-led design that recorded exactly zero real clicks in production. That kind of evidence-based reprioritisation is what I mean by outcome over output, and it is the discipline the ACoE needs at the backlog level.

I am comfortable in Scaled Agile environments with large team counts. At Scheidt & Bachmann I worked within a full SAFe setup across agile release trains and PI planning. I understand the PI Planning rhythm, the role of the TPO as the team-facing product voice, and the discipline required to keep backlogs prepared on time and refined continuously. Emirates is operating at a scale where that SAFe fluency is not optional, and I bring it without a learning curve.

On the aviation and airline domain specifically: I do not carry prior airline-industry employment, but I bring a Master's degree in Industrial Engineering with a logistics specialisation from TU Berlin, and a career pattern of rapidly internalising new technical domains, public sector labour markets, defence aerospace, health insurance, and becoming a credible internal expert within the first quarter. I am also actively targeting a move to Dubai and would arrive already committed to the location rather than treating relocation as a risk.

I would welcome the opportunity to discuss how my background maps onto the ACoE's current data product roadmap.

Best regards, *Philipp Hilbert*
